BLENDER ADD-ON FOR THE LIVE FOR SPEED VEHICLE EDITOR

LFS SRE Tools

Open vehicle-editor `.sre` cars in Blender, edit them with real modelling tools, see them in the editor's own light, and export them back.

VERSION	BLENDER	LICENCE
2.0.0	4.2 or newer, made on 5.2	GPL-3.0-or-later

AUTHOR

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Fig. 1 An imported car in Blender's Material Preview. The LFS look lights it like the vehicle editor: same sun, sky reflections, paint and floor.

IN ONE MINUTE

Quick start

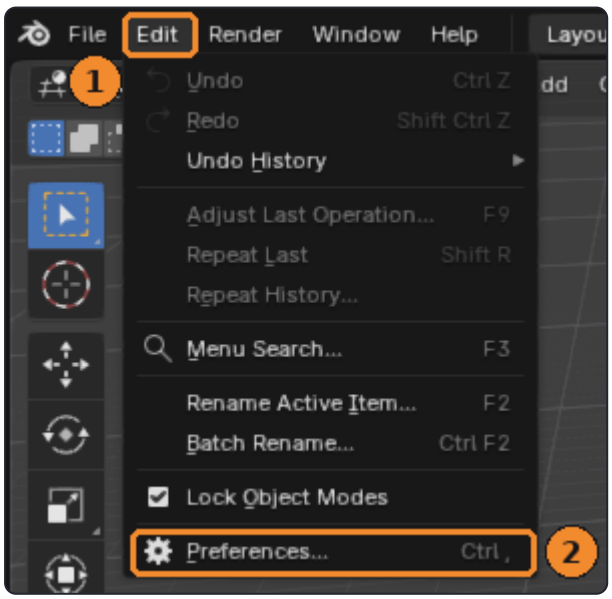
1. Install it with updates (Blender 4.2 or newer): **Preferences › Get Extensions**, the **Repositories** button at the top right, **+**, **Add Remote Repository**, paste `https://byemk.github.io/lfs-sre-tools/index.json`, **Create**, then search *LFS* and **Install**. Install has a picture of every click.
2. **File › Import › LFS SRE (.sre)** and pick a car from your LFS `data\3dob` folder.
3. Textures missing? Pick your LFS `data\png` folder in the box the LFS tab shows, and import again.
4. Edit in Solid view. Material Preview shows the car in the LFS editor's light.
5. **File › Export › LFS SRE** into `data\3dob` and open it in the vehicle editor. A file you write over is kept as `.sre.bak`.
6. Something wrong? **Copy Bug Report** at the bottom of the LFS SRE panel and paste it where you ask for help.

START HERE

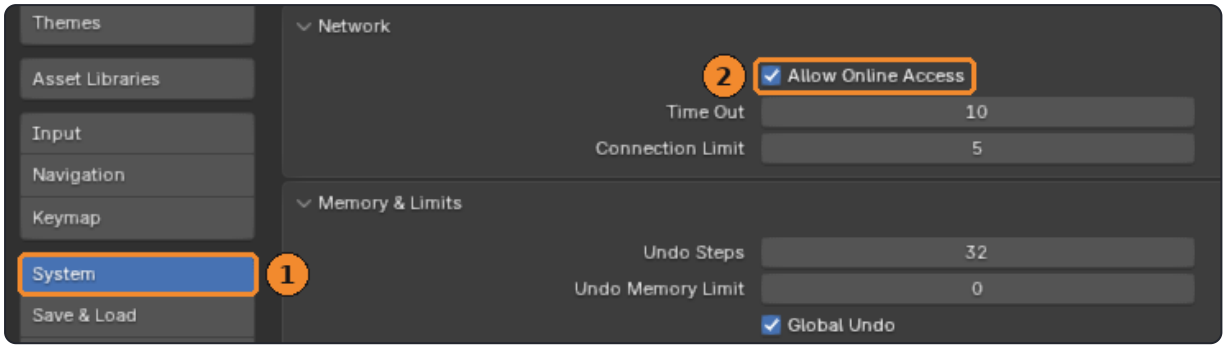
Install

You need Blender 4.2 or newer; it is tested on 4.2 LTS and 5.2. Install it from its update link and Blender keeps it up to date by itself. The orange numbers in the pictures are the clicks, in order.

1. Click **Edit** 1, then **Preferences** 2.



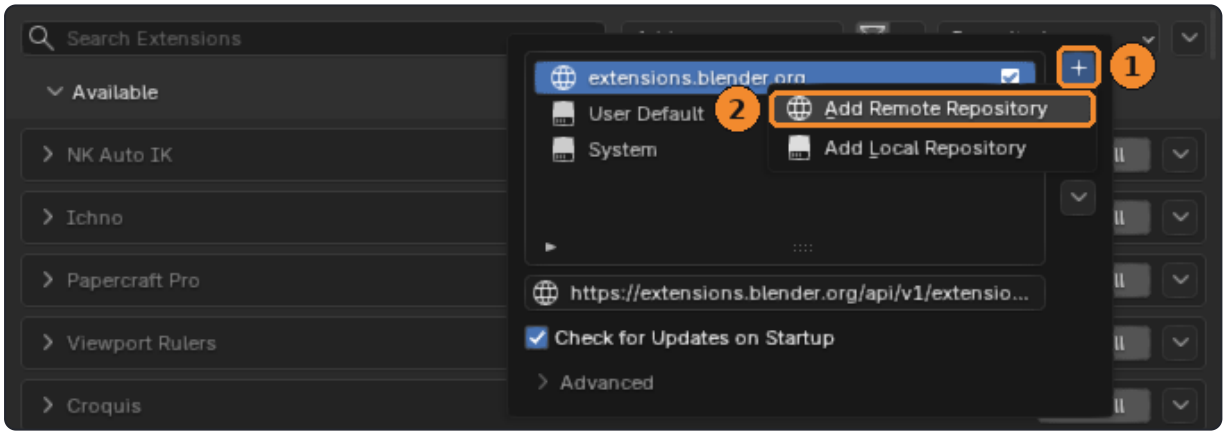
2 Click **System** 1 and tick **Allow Online Access** 2 under Network. Blender needs it to download extensions and to look for updates.



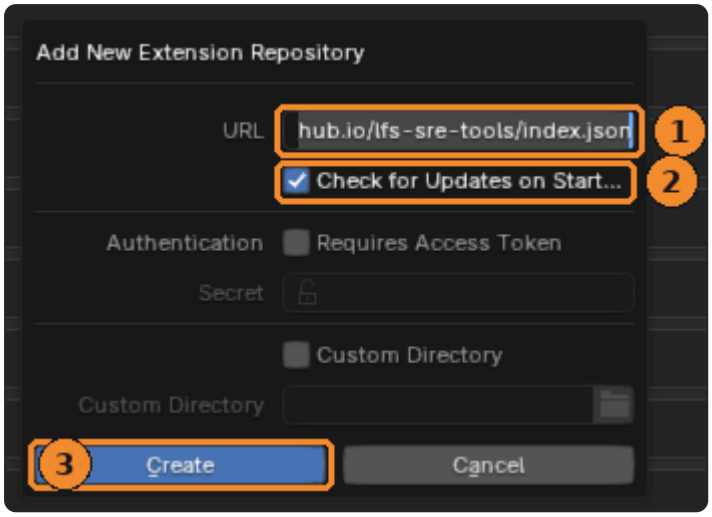
3 Click **Get Extensions** 1, then the **Repositories** button at the top right 2.



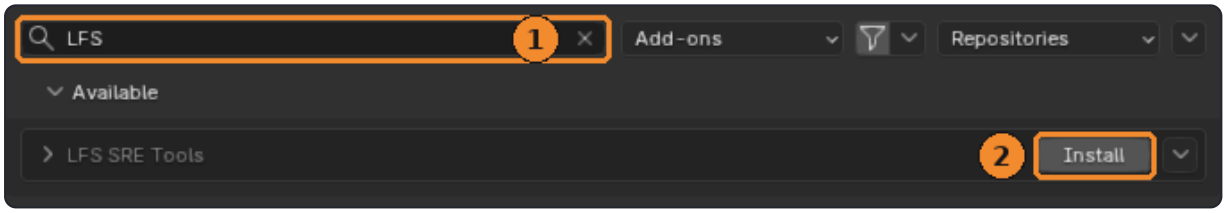
4 Click **+** 1 and choose **Add Remote Repository** 2.



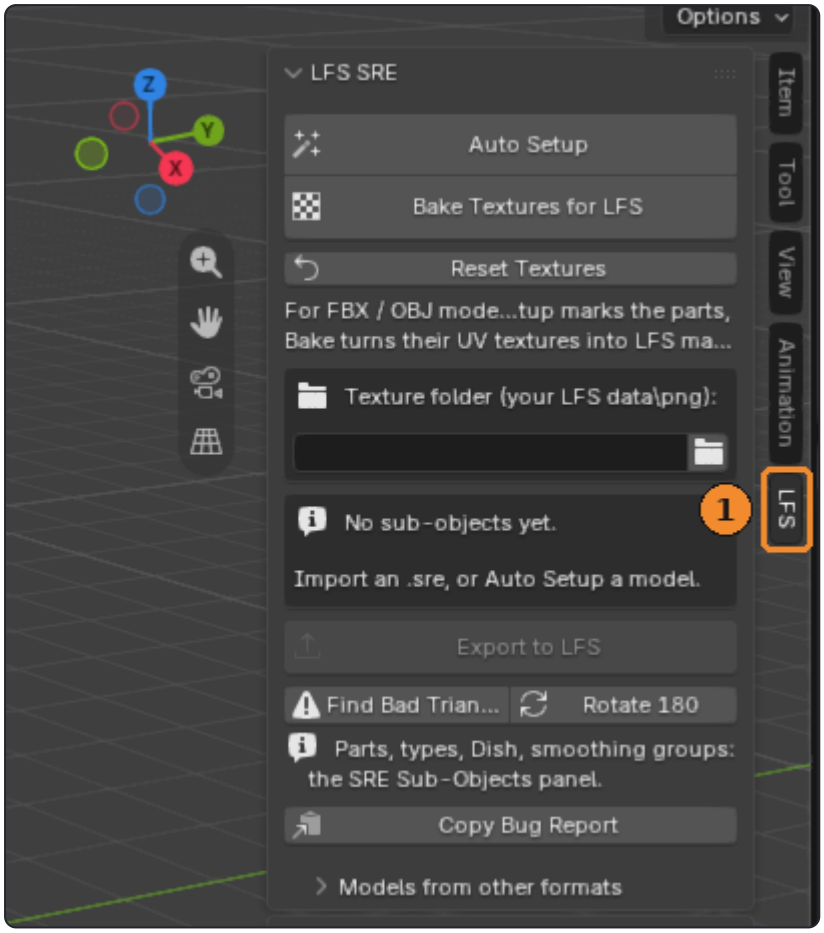
5 Paste `https://byemk.github.io/lfs-sre-tools/index.json` into **URL** (1), tick **Check for Updates on Startup** (2) and click **Create** (3).



6 Type *LFS* in the search box (1) and click **Install** beside **LFS SRE Tools** (2). It is switched on straight away.



7 Close the Preferences. With the mouse over the 3D View press `N` and click the **LFS** tab 1 .



Without updates: drag `lfs_sre_tools-2.0.0.zip` onto the Blender window and press **Install**, or use **Install from Disk...** in the small arrow menu at the top right of **Preferences › Add-ons** . Keep the zip zipped. A copy installed this way never updates itself.

Search for *LFS* in the Add-ons list and click the arrow beside **LFS SRE Tools** to see its settings.

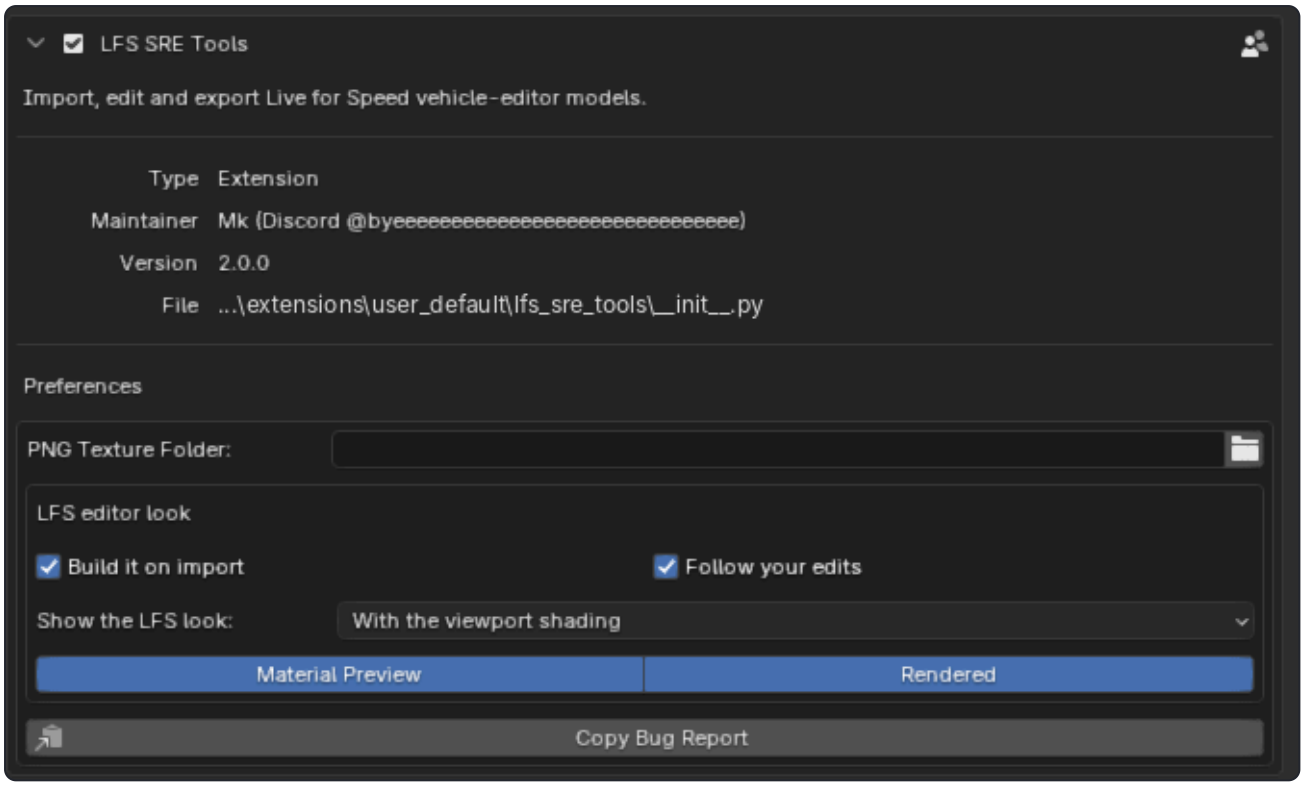


Fig. 2 The add-on in Preferences, expanded.

Its settings:

PNG Texture Folder

Your LFS texture folder (`data\png`). For imported cars you can leave it empty: the importer finds it next to the `data\3dob` folder the `.sre` is in. Set it if you start from FBX or OBJ models, because Bake Textures for LFS writes its pages there.

Build it on import

Builds the LFS look when a car is imported. A second Blender does that in the background for about half a minute, so switch it off on a slower PC: imports are quicker, and **Build LFS look** in the SRE Import panel makes the look when you want it.

Follow your edits

When you switch to Material Preview, the look first catches up with your edits. Off on a slower PC: the look stays as it is until you press **Rebuild LFS look**.

Show the LFS look

With the viewport shading (the default): Solid and Wireframe show the model you edit, the modes switched on below it show the LFS look. *As a separate scene*: the look gets its own scene and the LFS tab switches between the two.

Copy Bug Report

Copies the versions, these settings, the scene in short and the last messages, ready to paste where you ask for help. File paths are left out, so your user name stays private.

UPGRADING If you used the older single-file versions (*LFS SRE Exporter*, *LFS SRE Importer*), untick and remove them first. Two copies of the same tools register the same buttons and get in each other's way; the LFS tab shows a red warning while both are on.

SET IT UP ONCE

Getting updates

Installed from the update link (Install)? Then you are set: Blender looks for a new version when it starts and shows an **Update** button in Get Extensions. To look right away, click the small arrow at the far top right of Get Extensions and choose **Refresh Remote**. The update link is `https://byemk.github.io/lfs-sre-tools/index.json`.

1. A copy you installed from the zip does not update. Remove it in **Preferences › Add-ons** first.
2. Then add the update link as in Install and install **LFS SRE Tools** from Get Extensions.

From then on Blender tells you when there is a new version, and **Update** installs it. To look for updates Blender needs *Allow Online Access* (**Preferences › System**).

SHORTCUT The release page, `https://byemk.github.io/lfs-sre-tools/`, has an *lfs_sre_tools* link: dragged onto Blender it adds the repository and installs in one go. That does not work from every browser; if nothing happens, use the steps above.

CHECK THIS ON EVERY PC

Folders on your PC

The add-on needs to know one folder: your LFS **texture folder**, `data\png` inside your LFS folder (for example `C:\LFS\data\png`). On your PC it may be found by itself; on someone else's it may not, so check it once.

FOLDER	WHERE IT IS	WHAT TO DO
Texture folder	`data\png` in your LFS folder	Found by itself when the `.sre` is in `data\3dob`, or when the car's `.png` files sit next to the `.sre`. Anywhere else, set **PNG Texture Folder** in the add-on's preferences or in the box in the SRE Import panel. Blender saves it with its preferences. Once a folder has been found, later imports in the same `.blend` use it too. With nothing found, it also looks in the usual LFS places (`C:\LFS` and the like on each drive).

FOLDER	WHERE IT IS	WHAT TO DO
Cars	`data\3dob` in your LFS folder	Import from anywhere. Export into `data\3dob` so the vehicle editor lists the car.
Baked pages	the texture folder	**Bake Textures for LFS** writes its pages there, so set the folder before baking a model from FBX or OBJ.

If textures are missing after an import, the status bar says how many texture pages were not found and which folder was searched. The SRE Import panel in the LFS tab then shows a box to pick the folder. Pick it and import again.

`NOT MISSING` Pages called `s_mirr`, `s_clock` or `s_plate` are drawn by LFS itself (mirror, clock, number plate). They are not files and are not counted.

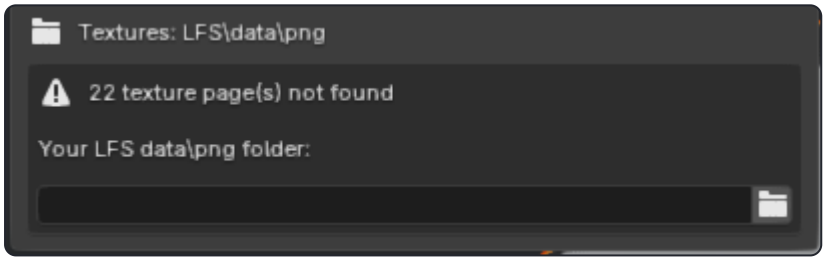


Fig. 3 A car imported from a folder with no textures nearby: the panel asks for the texture folder.

STEP 1

Import a car

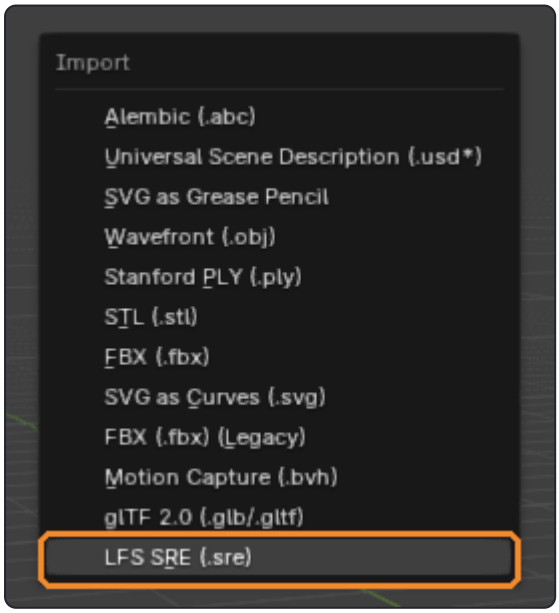


Fig. 4 The importer sits with Blender's own.

Choose **File › Import › LFS SRE (.sre)** and pick a car from your LFS `data\3dob` folder. The SRE Import panel in the LFS tab has the same button.

Each sub-object of the file becomes one Blender object, named as in the editor. The textures load from `data\png`. The LFS look is built in the background; Blender stays usable while it builds, and the SRE Import panel shows *LFS look: building…* until it is ready.

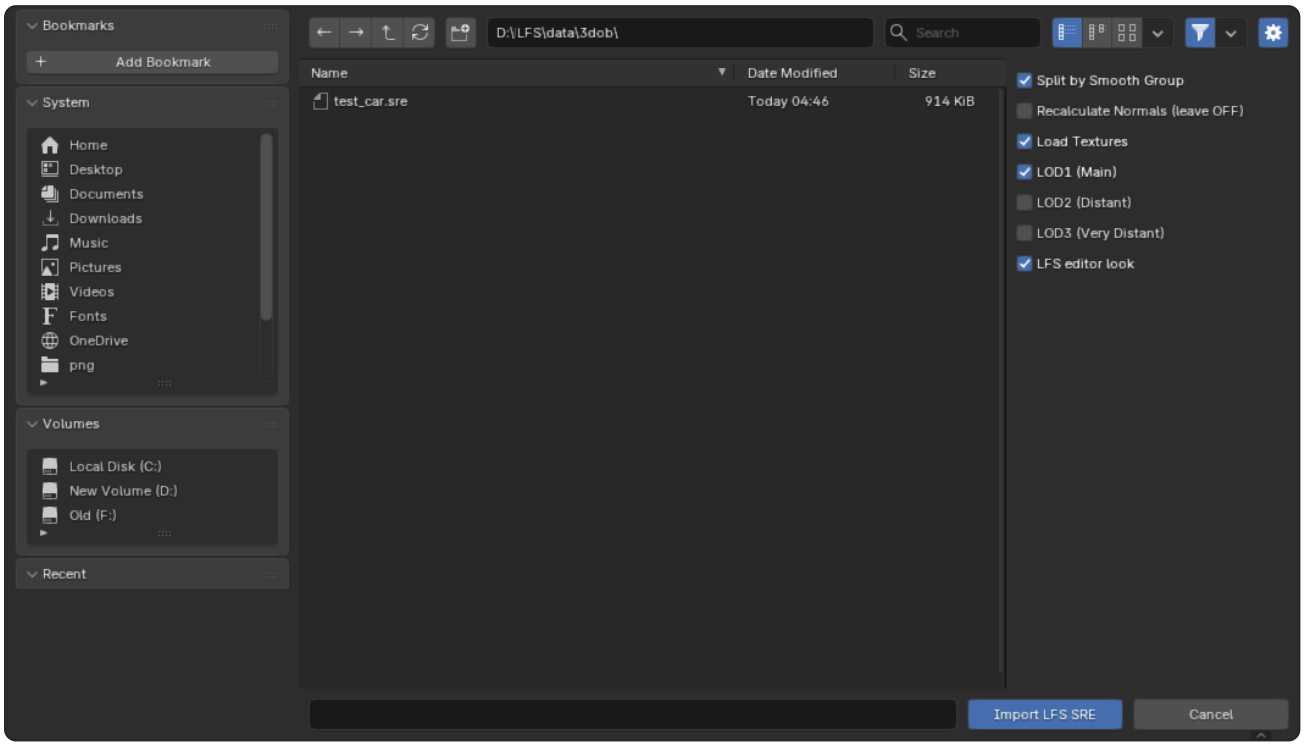


Fig. 5 The import window. The options are on the right; the defaults suit almost every car.

IMPORT OPTION	DEFAULT	WHAT IT DOES
LFS editor look	On	Builds the display-only copy lit like the vehicle editor (next section).
Load Textures	On	Loads the texture pages the car uses from the texture folder.
LOD1 (Main)	On	The detailed faces you see up close. This is what you edit.
LOD2, LOD3	Off	The low-detail faces LFS shows far away. They are kept in the file either way.
Recalculate Normals	Off	Leave it off. Interiors and wheels face inward on purpose.
Split by Smooth Group	On	Only for older `.sre` files that did not come from the vehicle editor.

STEP 2

The look and the model

An imported car has two faces in Blender, and the viewport shading buttons (top right of the 3D View, or `Z`) switch between them.



Fig. 6 Material Preview and Rendered show the **LFS look**, a copy you cannot edit.

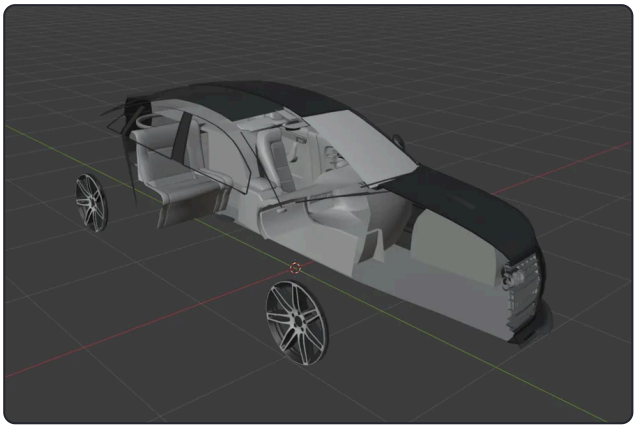


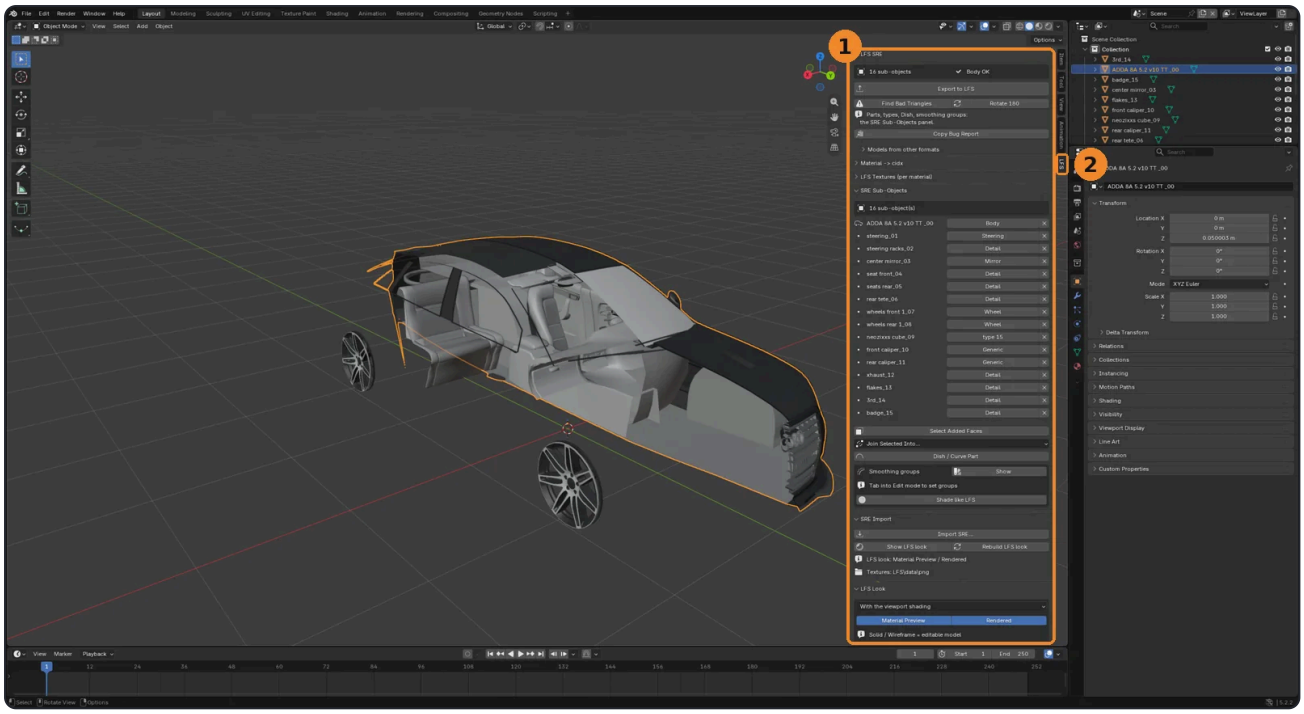
Fig. 7 Solid and Wireframe show the **model you edit** and export.

- **The look follows your edits.** Change the mesh in Solid, switch to Material Preview, and the look is rebuilt from what an export would write at that moment. You see the car the way the editor will show it before you export anything.
- **Why one side looks open in Solid.** Faces marked as mirrored in the `.sre` exist once in Blender. LFS draws their mirror image on the other side of the car, and so does the look.
- **The lighting** is in the LFS Look panel of the LFS tab: sun turn, height, strength and colour, shadow fill, sky reflections and the two paint colours. The defaults are measured from the LFS editor.
- Blender compiles shaders before it shows the look for the first time, so give it a few seconds. Switching back and forth is quick after that.
- **On a slower PC** switch off *Build it on import* and *Follow your edits* in the add-on's preferences. Build or rebuild the look with the button in SRE Import when you want to see it.

WHERE THE TOOLS LIVE

The LFS tab

Press `N` over the 3D View to open the sidebar, then pick the **LFS** tab on its right edge. Everything except import and export lives here.



`Fig. 8` The sidebar (1) with the LFS tab picked (2). Drag the sidebar's left edge to make it wider.

LFS SRE

The sub-object count with a body check, **Export to LFS**, Find Bad Triangles, Rotate 180 and Copy Bug Report. For a model from another format also Auto Setup and Bake Textures for LFS, and the closed *Models from other formats* section with its tools.

Material → cidx

Which LFS map each material exports to. *cidx* is the editor's map number; imported materials already have theirs.

LFS Textures (per material)

Which texture page each material exports with.

SRE Sub-Objects

The car's parts and their types, Select Added Faces, Join Selected Into..., Dish / Curve Part and the smoothing-group tools.

SRE Import

Import, switch between the look and the editable model, rebuild the look, and the texture folder in use.

LFS Look

The look's lighting and where it shows.

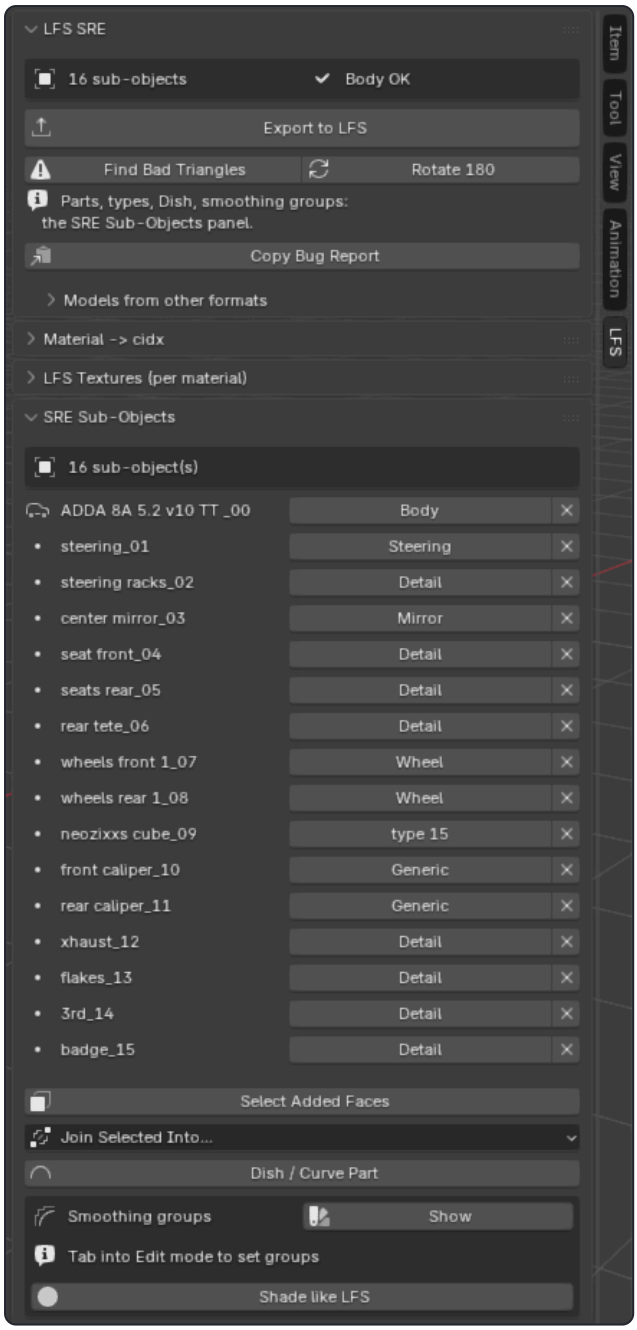


Fig. 9 Top of the tab.

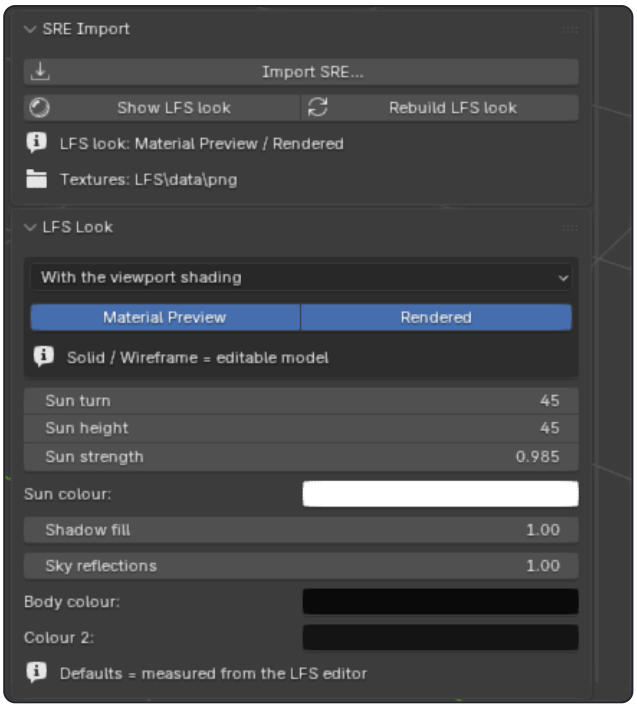


Fig. 10 Scrolled down.

STEP 3

Edit and export

The imported objects are ordinary Blender meshes. Move points, extrude, cut, delete, add faces, swap materials. Work in Solid view and look at the result in Material Preview.

To export, use `File › Export › LFS SRE (.sre)` or **Export to LFS** in the LFS tab, then open the file in the LFS vehicle editor.

- A sub-object you did not touch is written back **byte for byte**.
- In a sub-object you edited, every face that is still where it was keeps its map, mirror flag, LOD and smoothing group from the file. New and changed faces take them from their material and their neighbours.

- Export an unchanged import and you get the same file back. That makes a quick test that everything is in order.
- The export window starts where the car went last, else where it came from, with its name. Writing over an `.sre` keeps the old file as `name.sre.bak`; to go back, rename it to `.sre`.
- The status bar says when the car uses texture pages your `data\png` does not have (the editor shows them blank), and when the file is saved outside a `data\3dob` folder (the editor lists cars from there). A progress number on the cursor shows a big export is still working.

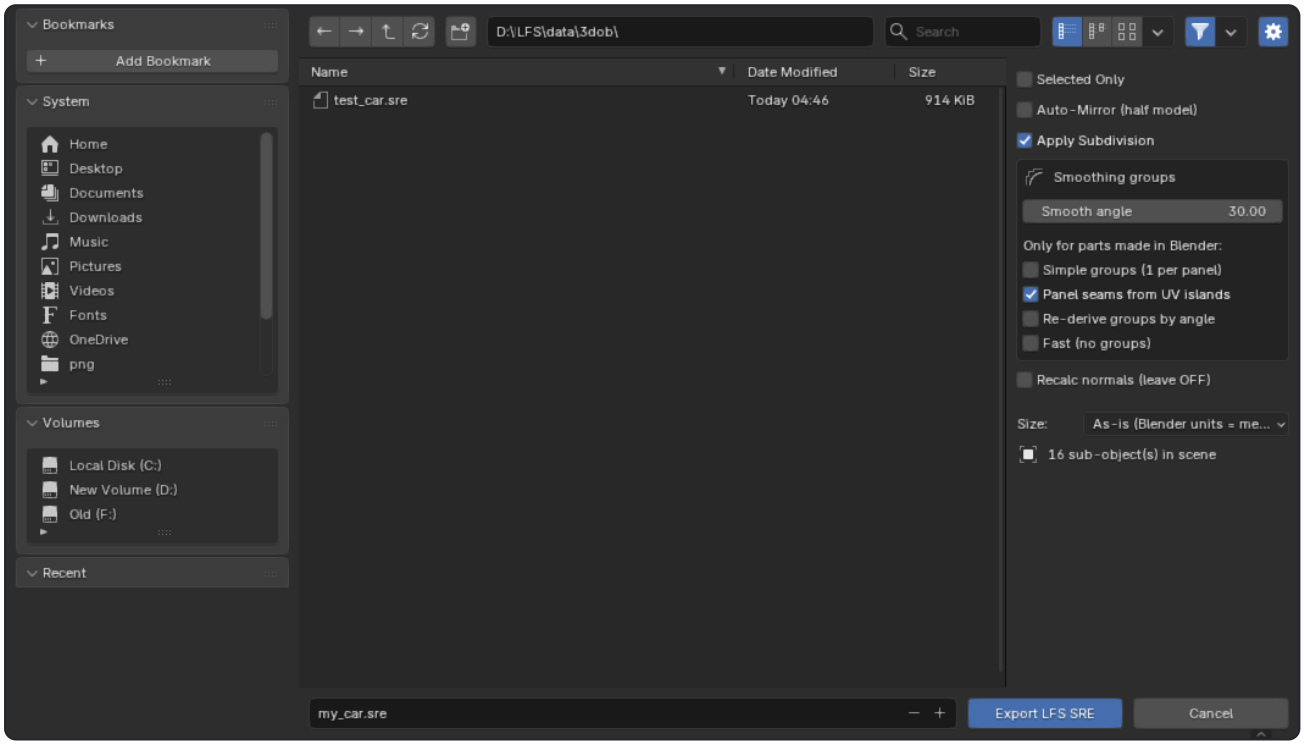


Fig. 11 The export window with its options. Save into `data\3dob` so the vehicle editor finds the file. Most of the Smoothing groups box only matters for parts made in Blender.

EXPORT OPTION	DEFAULT	WHAT IT DOES
Selected Only	Off	Export only the selected sub-objects.
Auto-Mirror (half model)	Off	For a mesh that is half a car: LFS mirrors it. Leave it off for full models.
Apply Subdivision	On	Bakes Subdivision Surface modifiers into the export. Turn it off if a part goes over the 32767-point limit.
Smooth angle	30°	Faces that meet at more than this angle get a hard edge. It decides which new or edited faces of an imported part shade into the faces around them. The window starts from the angle the scene uses.

EXPORT OPTION	DEFAULT	WHAT IT DOES
Simple groups (1 per panel)	Off	Parts made in Blender only: one group per panel, worked out from the UV islands.
Panel seams from UV islands	On	Parts made in Blender only: a hard edge along the borders of UV islands, for game models whose panel gaps are only painted on.
Re-derive groups by angle	Off	Parts made in Blender only: hard edges by the smooth angle as well as the sharp edges you marked. A part with no sharp edges marked is split by the angle anyway.
Fast (no groups)	Off	Parts made in Blender only: no smoothing groups at all. Quick, for scenery.
Recalc normals	Off	Leave it off; it can flip interiors and wheels.
Size	As-is	Blender units are metres. *Fit to real length* scales the model so its longest side matches a length you type.

TIP Save to a new file name and check it in the vehicle editor before you overwrite a car you care about.

HOW A CAR IS BUILT

Sub-objects and new parts

An `.sre` car is a list of sub-objects: one body plus parts such as wheels, the steering wheel, the mirror and the interior. In Blender each one is an object, and SRE Sub-Objects lists them with their type.

TYPE	SHOWN AS	USED FOR
0	Body	The main body. A car has exactly one; **Export to LFS** stays grey until it does.
3	Detail	Most parts: interior, trim, details. Auto Setup also uses it for wheels.
2	Steering	The steering wheel.

TYPE	SHOWN AS	USED FOR
10	Mirror	The interior rear-view mirror.
1	Generic	A generic part.
12	Wheel	The road wheels in cars made in the vehicle editor.
other	type N	Kept exactly as the file has it.

- Click a type to change it. A small dialog opens with *Keep as it is* selected, so nothing changes by accident. The `×` beside it unmarks the part.
- A part file (a single wheel or an interior `.sre`) has no body. That is fine: export it with **File › Export**.
- **Select Added Faces** selects everything you modelled since the import in the active part. Handy on triangulated meshes.

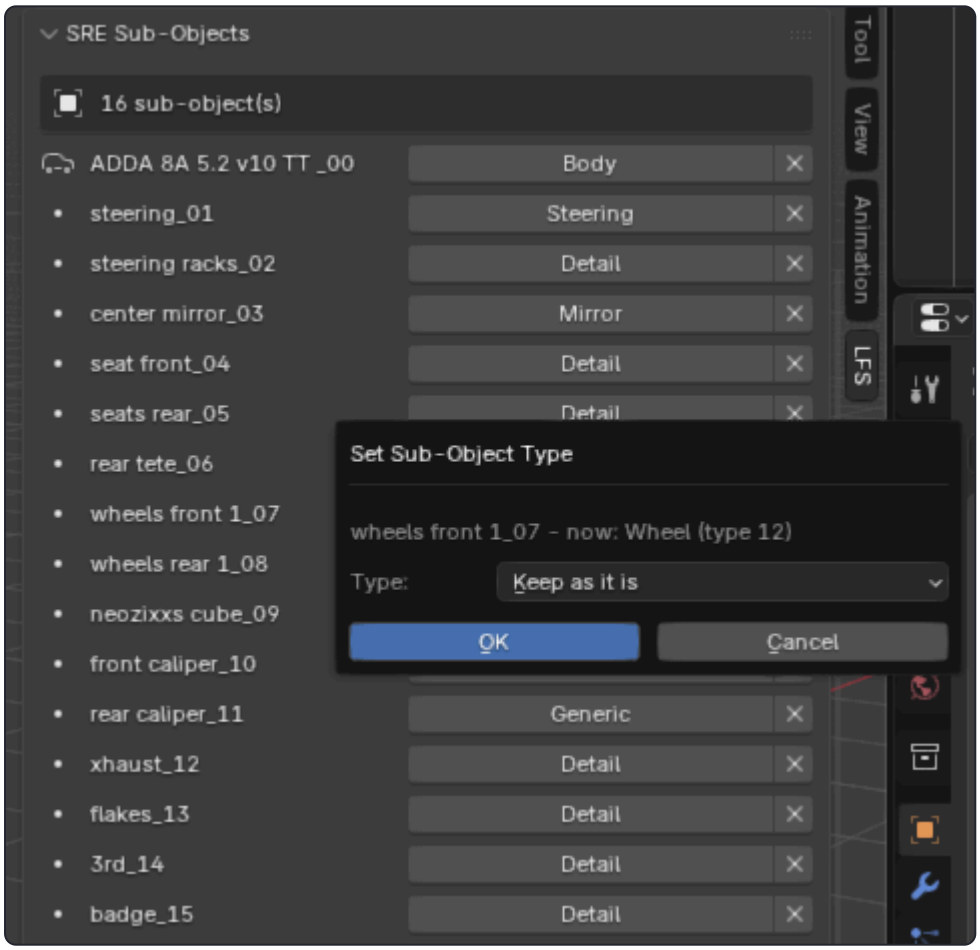
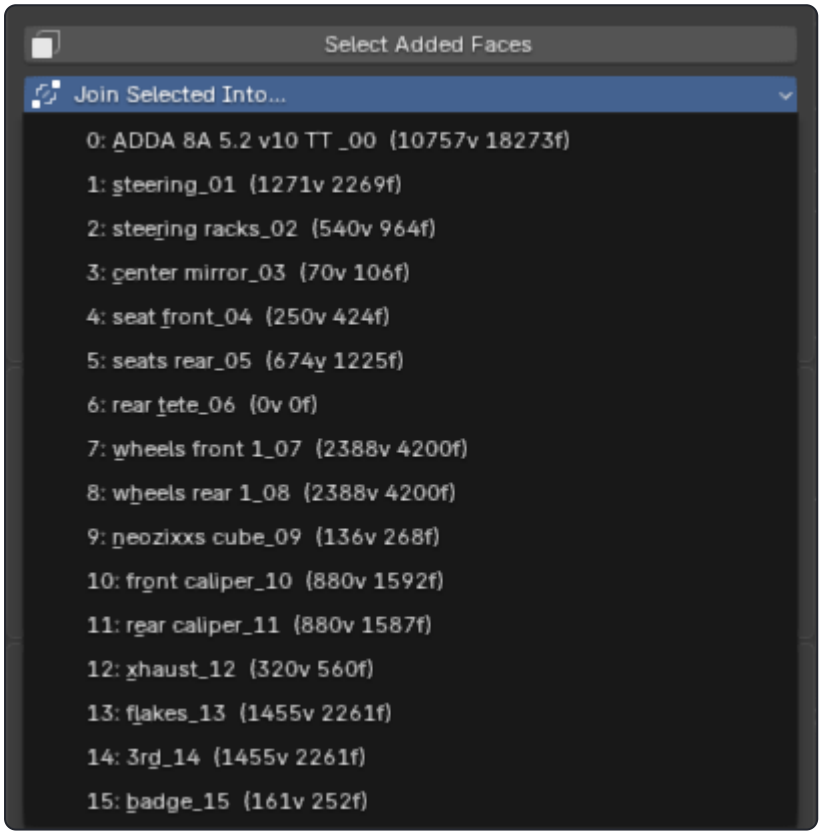


Fig. 12 Changing a part's type.

Add a part to an imported car

1. Model the part, or import or append it, in Solid view.
2. Give it materials. One of the car's own materials (paint, chrome, glass) makes it look like that part. A new material exports as its plain colour.
3. Select it, open **Join Selected Into...** in SRE Sub-Objects and pick the part it belongs to, such as the body for a spoiler.
4. Export. The new faces get smoothing groups by themselves (see below).



`Fig. 13` **Join Selected Into...** lists the car's parts.

`WHY JOIN` **Mark Selected Part(s)** makes a separate new sub-object instead. On big cars it can stop with *Map table too long*, because the editor crashes past about 236 maps. A joined part uses the maps of the part it joins.

`SHAPING TOOL`

Dish / Curve Part

Curves a part in or out with a smooth falloff: a dished wheel face, a domed panel, a concave diffuser, a flared lip. The centre, the axis and the radius come from the part itself, so nothing has to be dragged by hand.

1. Select the part. In Object mode it works on the whole object; in Edit mode on the selected faces.
2. Click **Dish / Curve Part** in SRE Sub-Objects.
3. Open the panel at the bottom left of the 3D View (or press `F9`) and set **Depth**. Negative pulls the centre in, positive pushes it out. The first time, Depth is 0 and nothing moves until you set it; after that the button repeats your last settings.

WHEELS For a concave wheel, set **Zone** to *Ring*: the spokes bow in while the hub and the rim's edge stay where they are. *Centre* moves the hub as well, and it comes out of the back of the rim (from the front it looks like a second rim behind the first).



Fig. 14 The front wheel as imported.



Fig. 15 After Dish / Curve Part: the *Deep dish* curve, Depth −0.05 m, from 0.12 to 0.85 of the radius.

SETTING	WHAT IT DOES
Shape	Smooth, Round, Cone, Bell, Power curve, or Custom curve (draw it yourself).
Depth (m)	How far the centre moves. Negative = in (a dish), positive = out (a dome).
Start / End radius	Where the curve starts and stops, as a share of the radius. 0.3 keeps the inner 30% flat, like a centre cap.
Taper (m)	Also moves points sideways: negative narrows the middle, positive flares it.

SETTING	WHAT IT DOES
Zone	Strongest at the centre, at the outer edge (a deep-dish lip) or halfway out (a ring).
Axis	*Auto* uses the direction the part is thinnest in: the axle on a wheel.
Centre	The selection centre, the 3D cursor or the object origin.
From original shape	On: re-applied from the shape before the first dish, so a smaller Depth makes it shallower again. Off: adds on top, to stack a dish and a lip.

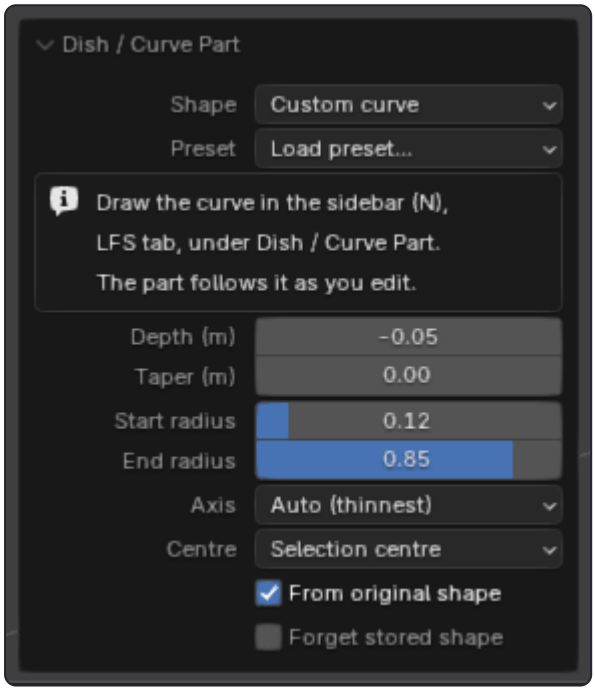


Fig. 16 The settings panel.

Draw your own curve

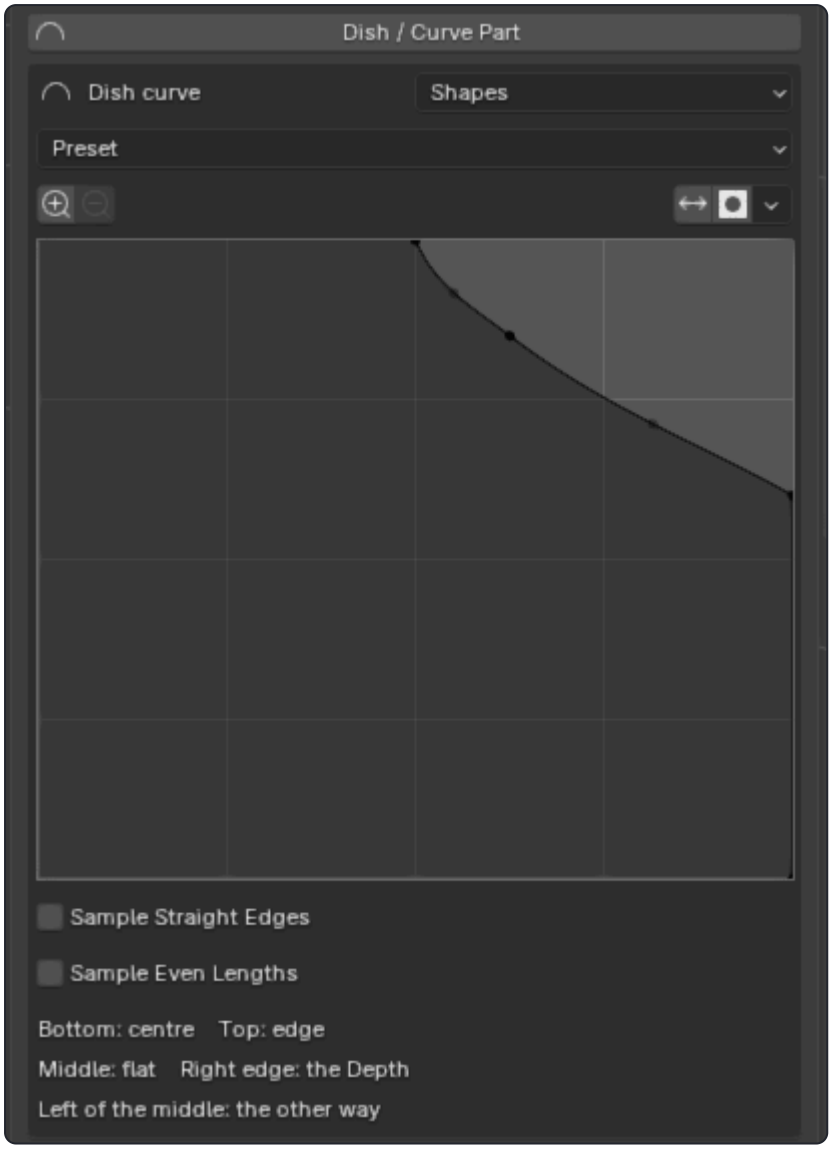


Fig. 17 The curve under the Dish button.

Set **Shape** to *Custom curve* and the curve appears in the sidebar, under the Dish button.

- **Bottom** is the centre of the part (Start radius), **top** is its edge (End radius).
- The line starts straight up the **middle**: flat, nothing moves.
- Bend it to the **right** and that ring moves by the Depth. The right edge is the whole Depth. Left of the middle moves the other way.
- Drag the points; `Ctrl` + click adds one. The part follows when you let go, in Solid and in Material Preview.
- **Shapes** loads a starting curve: flat, linear, smooth, round, bell, deep dish, lip or ring.



Fig. 18 The dished wheel in Material Preview. The look follows the edit.

SHADING

Smoothing groups

LFS shades by smoothing group, a number from 0 to 23 on every face (LFS has 24). Faces of one group that share a point blend smoothly; a different group makes a hard edge. Each face also has a contribution level (overridden, default, medium, high), and at each point only the faces with the highest level count.

What an export writes

- A face that is still where it was in the file keeps its group.
- A face you added or changed joins the group of a neighbour across a smooth edge: not marked sharp, under the smooth angle (*Smooth angle* in the export window, 30° by default), and shaded smooth.
- Otherwise it gets a group that no face sharing a point with it uses. Extrusions come out crisp; a part welded on flush shades into the panel.
- A group you set by hand always wins.
- Every Blender face keeps one group, so a quad never gets a crease across its diagonal, and new groups stay within LFS's 0 to 23.

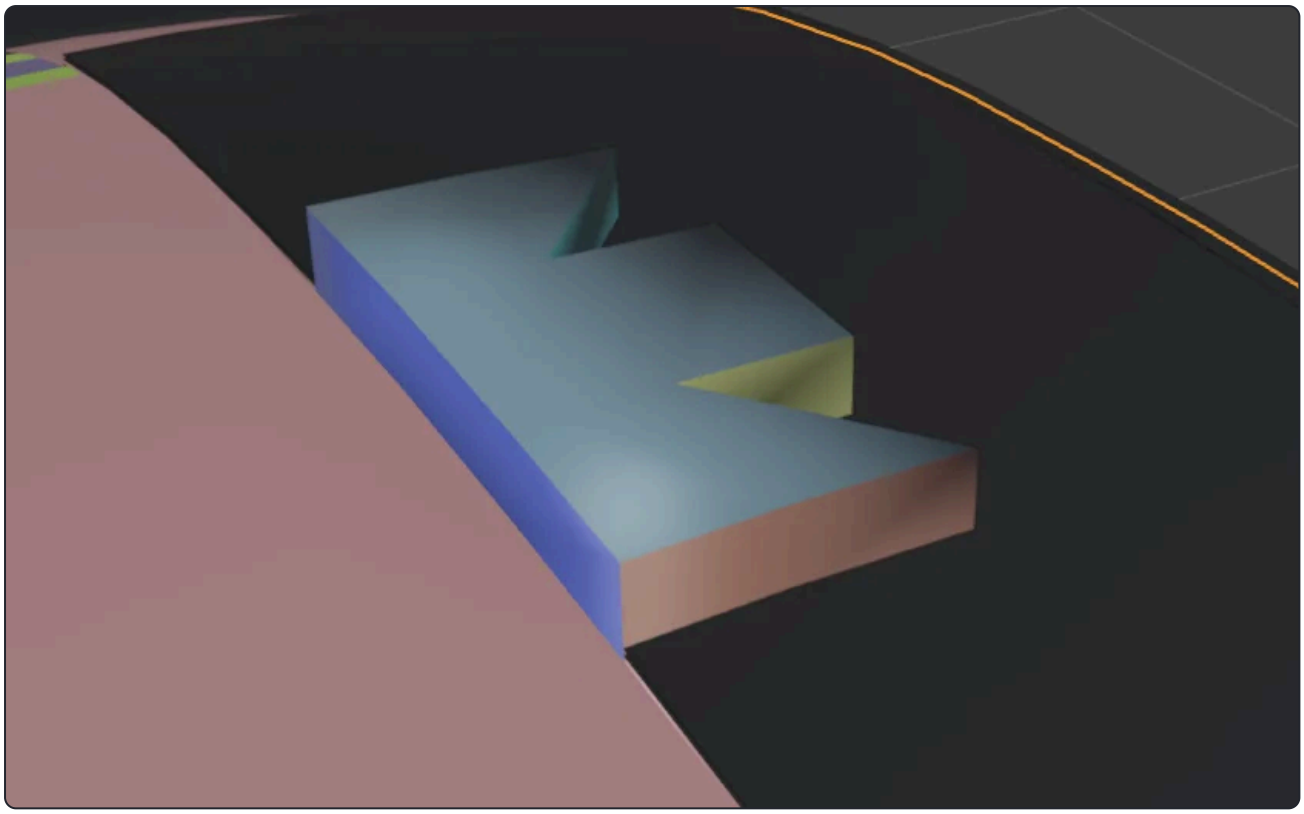
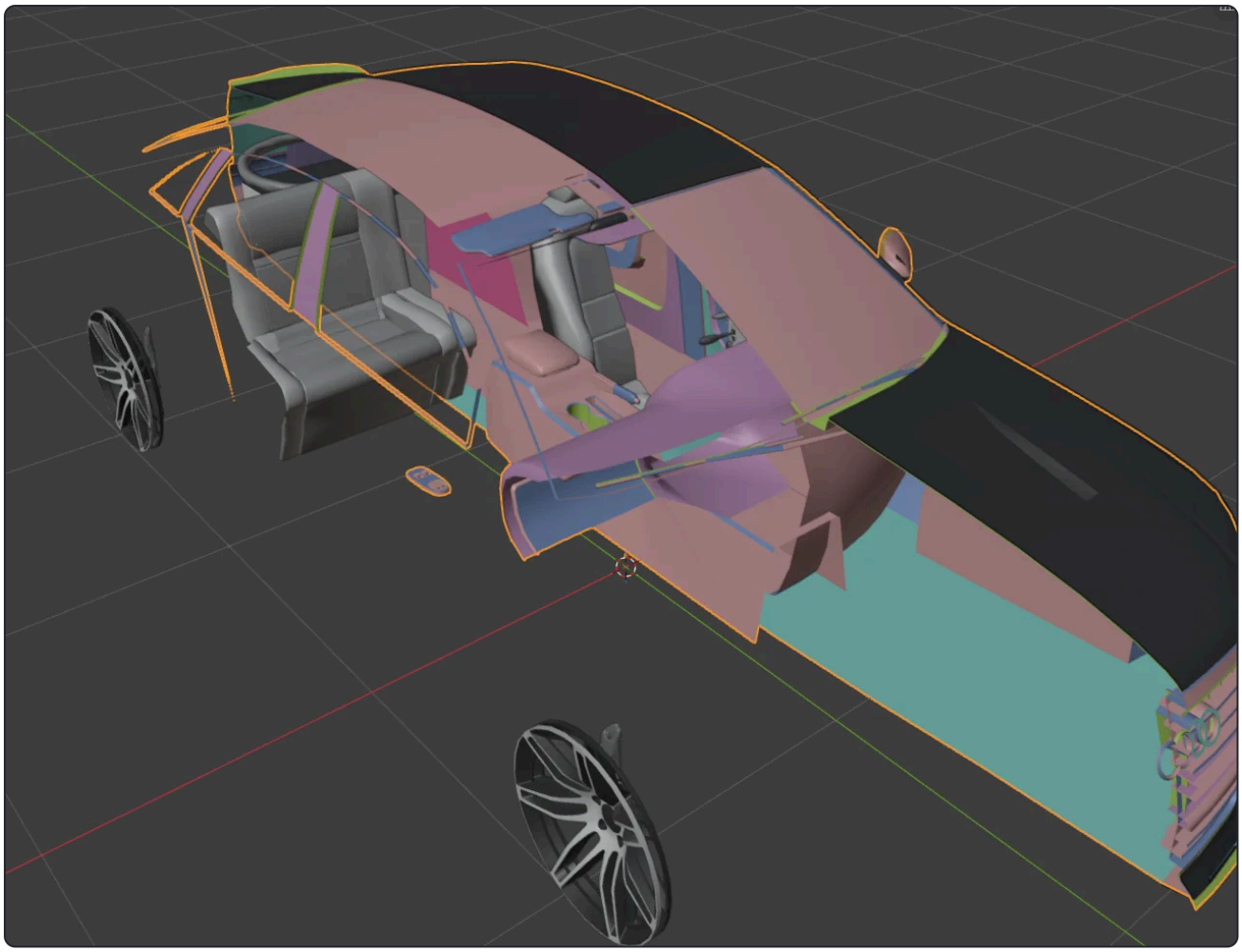


Fig. 19 A roof panel extruded upward, coloured by group: the raised cap and each new wall get groups of their own (crisp edges), and the roof around keeps the group it had in the file.



`Fig. 20` **Show** colours the active part by the group each face will get, new and edited faces included. Press it again to hide.

New group

A group nothing else in the part uses: smooth inside the selection, a hard edge all round.

Join around

The group of the faces around the selection, so it shades into them.

Flat

A group of its own for every face: faceted.

Automatic

Forget what was set by hand and let the export decide.

Number...

Type a group number from 0 to 23, like in the editor.

Select group

Selects every face in the same group as the selected ones.

Shade like LFS

Sets Blender's normals the way LFS will shade the part, worked out from the triangles the export writes, so you see the result before exporting. It marks the edges between different groups sharp, as the importer does, so Blender does not blend across them, and leaves flat and smooth faces as they are.

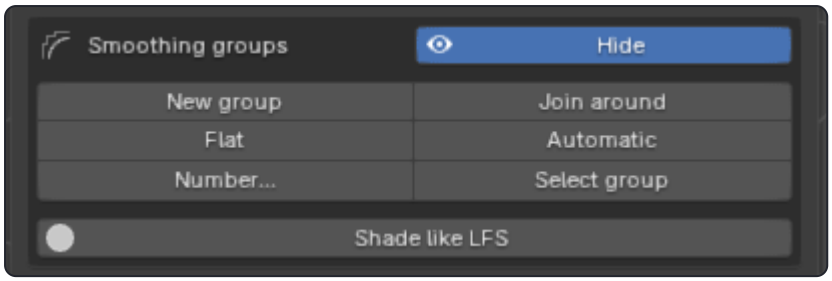


Fig. 21 In Edit mode the box adds the tools for the selected faces.

FBX, OBJ, GLTF

Cars from other formats

For a model that did not come from an `.sre`:

1. Import it into Blender. Blender units are metres; the export can also fit the car to its real length.
2. **Auto Setup** groups the meshes by name into Body, Interior, Wheels and Steering, joins each group and marks them as sub-objects. Check that the LFS SRE panel says *Body OK*.
3. **Bake Textures for LFS** turns the model's UV textures into LFS texture pages and maps, and writes the pages into your LFS `data\png` folder. Until that folder is known, the LFS SRE panel shows a box to pick it. **Reset Textures** undoes the bake.
4. **Export to LFS** and open the car in the vehicle editor.

- The car faces backwards in LFS: **Rotate 180** turns every part.
- The tools for these models are in the closed **Models from other formats** section of the LFS SRE panel: Mark Selected Part(s) for a mesh Auto Setup missed, Prep Steering and Spin for a new steering wheel, the mesh repairs and the texture-map tools.
- LFS draws each face from one side only. **Fix Inside-Out Shells** turns shells whose faces point inward; **Mark Double-Sided** makes thin sheets such as seat backs and glass visible from both sides. Mark Double-Sided doubles every sheet it finds, so check the triangle count afterwards.
- Bake never writes over a page that is already in `data\png`. A model texture with the same name as one of the editor's pages (a `carpet.png`, say) gets a name of its own, such as `carpet_2`, and each `.blend` keeps its own names for its baked pages.
- Bake is for models from other formats. On a car imported from an `.sre` it says so and changes nothing: give a new part one of the car's materials or a plain colour.

EVERY BUTTON

Tool reference

Hover any button in Blender for its full tooltip. Every tool can be undone with `Ctrl` + `Z`.

BUTTON	WHAT IT DOES
LFS SRE panel	
Export to LFS	Exports the scene. Needs exactly one body.
Find Bad Triangles	Finds broken triangles that came with a file: zero-area ones and long thin slivers.
Rotate 180	Turns every marked part half a turn, for a car that faces backwards.
Copy Bug Report	Copies versions, settings and the last messages, to paste where you ask for help.
Auto Setup	Groups a model's meshes by name into Body, Interior, Wheels and Steering, joins and marks them. Shown for models from other formats.
Bake Textures for LFS	Bakes UV textures into LFS texture pages plus one map per face cluster. Run it after the parts are marked, before export.
Reset Textures	Undoes Bake Textures for LFS.
Models from other formats (closed section of the LFS SRE panel)	
Mark Selected Part(s)	Turns the selected meshes into new sub-objects. On an imported car use Join Selected Into... instead.
Prep Steering, Spin	Lays a steering wheel flat with its origin at the rim centre, then turns its spokes.
Purge Unused Maps	Deletes map entries no face uses and renumbers the rest.
Weld Panel Gaps	Closes small gaps between neighbouring panels of the active object.
Mark Double-Sided	Finds faces seen from both sides and makes the export write a reversed twin.
Fix Inside-Out Shells	Turns closed shells whose faces point inward.
Set Tile Size	Sets one tile size for every split map whose material name matches, so leather tiles line up.

BUTTON	WHAT IT DOES
Set Texture by Name...	Gives every material whose name contains a word the same LFS texture page.
Auto Split All Maps	Splits every sizeable tiling material by facing direction, except the body.
Split Map by Direction	Splits the active material's map into top, bottom, front, back and sides, so textures don't smear on curves.
Pro-Map Material	Maps the active material with small tiles aligned to each part, like hand-made interiors.
Material → cidx and LFS Textures	
Auto-Map, Force All	Assigns map numbers to materials by name; Force All redoes the ones already set.
Reset All	Removes every material's map number.
Bake Texture → Palette	Turns the active mesh's texture into up to about 250 face colours.
Texture page picker	Chooses what a material exports with: a stock page from `data\png`, colour only, or automatic.
SRE Sub-Objects	
Type button, ×	Change a part's type (a dialog), or unmark it.
Select Added Faces	Selects the faces modelled since the import.
Join Selected Into...	Joins the selected new meshes into the part you pick, so they export with it.
Dish / Curve Part	Curves a part in or out. See Dish / Curve Part.
Smoothing groups	Show, set and preview groups. See Smoothing groups.
SRE Import and LFS Look	
Import SRE...	The same as **File › Import › LFS SRE (.sre)**.
Show LFS look, Editable model	Switch between the look and the model you edit.
Build / Rebuild LFS look	Builds the look again from the model as it is now.

BUTTON	WHAT IT DOES
Lighting	Sun turn, height, strength and colour, shadow fill, sky reflections, body colours.

TROUBLESHOOTING

When something is off

Textures are missing

Keep the LFS folder layout, with `data\3dob` beside `data\png`, or set **PNG Texture Folder** in the add-on's preferences. Then import again. SRE Import shows the texture folder in use.

Material Preview shows a plain model, not the look

The look may still be building (SRE Import says so), or it was switched off when you imported. Click **Build LFS look** in SRE Import. Also check *Show the LFS look* in the add-on's preferences.

Undo took the LFS look away

The look has its own step, *LFS look*, in **Edit › Undo History**. Undoing past it goes back to before the look was built, and SRE Import says *Undo removed the LFS look*. Redo with `Ctrl` `Shift` `Z`, or click **Build LFS look**.

A dished wheel shows a second rim behind it

Dish with Zone *Centre* moved the hub and the inner spokes back, out of the rim. Undo, and dish again with Zone *Ring*: the spokes bow in, the hub and the rim's edge stay.

The editor says "points have bad normals"

Usually triangles that stand exactly on the centre line of a mirrored part, often the wall an extrusion leaves along the centre. The mirror copy of such a triangle is the same triangle facing the other way, so their normals cancel. Delete them and export again. The export already warns about it, with the part and the number of points.

Every layer shows when I open the export in the modeller

The modeller does not save which layers are shown, whoever saved the file. The vehicle's configurations keep that, in its `.veh`: load the model into the vehicle and each configuration shows its own layers again.

The export has two cars in it

An export writes every imported part in the scene, and importing a second car adds its parts beside the first (the importer warns about it). Delete the old car's parts first, or import into a new scene.

Bake says the texture folder is not set

Pick your LFS `data\png` folder in the box in the LFS SRE panel, or set **PNG Texture Folder** in the add-on's preferences, then bake again.

The car faces backwards in LFS

Click **Rotate 180** and export again. (An older .blend may have *Global Y-flip* switched on: the LFS SRE panel then shows it in red; click it to switch it off.)

Export to LFS is grey

The scene needs exactly one body (type 0). The LFS SRE panel says *No Body!* or how many bodies it found. Part files without a body export from **File › Export**.

"Map table too long"

The vehicle editor crashes past about 236 maps. Run **Purge Unused Maps**, or run Bake Textures for LFS again (it stays under the limit). On an imported car, add parts with **Join Selected Into...**.

Part of the car is invisible from one side in LFS

LFS draws faces from one side. Use **Fix Inside-Out Shells** for closed shapes, or **Mark Double-Sided** for thin sheets.

A new part shades with odd hard edges

Click **Show** under Smoothing groups to see what the export will write. In Edit mode, **Join around** blends faces into their neighbours; **New group** gives a clean hard edge all round. **Shade like LFS** previews the result.

The LFS tab shows a red warning

Another copy of the LFS SRE add-ons is switched on, usually the older single-file exporter or importer. Turn it off in **Preferences › Add-ons**; two copies register the same buttons.

Blender is slow or looks frozen

Watch the cursor: a number on it means an import, export or bake is still working. On a slower PC switch off *Build it on import* and *Follow your edits* for the LFS look in the add-on's preferences.

Asking for help

Click **Copy Bug Report** (bottom of the LFS SRE panel, or the add-on's preferences) and paste it with your question: it says which versions you have and what Blender reported.

The look takes a while to appear

Blender compiles shaders before it shows the look for the first time. Give it a few seconds; switching back and forth is quick after that. Right after an import the look may still be building.

ABOUT

Credits and licence

LFS SRE Tools is made by **Mk** (Discord `@byeeeeeeeeeeeeeeeeeeeeeeeeeeeeee`), with code and this guide written together with Claude.

It is free software under the GNU General Public License, version 3 or later. You may use it, share it and change it. If you share a changed version, share its source under the same licence. The full text is in the `LICENSE` file in the zip.

This is a fan-made tool. It is not made by or connected to the Live for Speed developers.

Somewhere in the source code a cat is waiting. If you find it, it tells you what to type.
